# Choose the Right Database for Your Application

Databases are key components of many an app and choosing the right option is an elaborate process. This article examines the role that databases play in apps, giving readers tips on selecting the right option. It also discusses the pros and cons of a few select databases.

Every other day we discover a new online application that tries to make our lives more convenient. And as soon as we get to know about it, we register ourselves for that application without giving it a second thought. After the one-time registration, whenever we want to use that app again, we just need to log in with our user name and password —the app or system automatically remembers all our data that was provided during the registration process. Ever wondered how a system is able to identify us and recollect all our data on the basis of just a user name and password? It's all because of the database in which all our information or data gets stored when we register for any application.

Similarly, when we browse through millions of product items available on various online shopping applications like Amazon, or post our selfies on Facebook to let all our friends see them, it's the database that is making all this possible.

According to Wikipedia, a database is an organised collection of data. Now, why does data need to be in an organised form? Let's flash back to a few years ago, when we didn't have any database and government offices like electricity boards stored large heaps of files containing the data of all users. Imagine how cumbersome it must have been to enter details pertaining to a customer's consumption of electricity, payments made or pending, etc, if the names were not listed alphabetically. It would have been time consuming as well. It's the same with databases. If the data is not present in an organised form, then the processing time in fetching any data is quite long. The data stored in a database can be in any organised form—schemas, reports, tables, views or any other objects. These are basically organised in such way as to help easy retrieval of information. The data stored in files can get lost when the papers of these files get older and, hence, get destroyed. But in a database, we can store data for millions of years without any such fear. Data will get lost only when the system crashes, which is why we keep a backup.